# CPI Inflation Case Study – Storytelling Practice

This document is designed to help you practice explaining a CPI Inflation Excel case study in a clear, business-focused storytelling format. Use it to prepare for Excel-based interviews where you need to explain data analysis, insights, and recommendations.

## Storytelling Flow to Practice:

- 1. Context (Problem Framing) – State the business problem in one or two sentences.
- 2. Data Preparation – Briefly explain how you ensured clean, accurate data.
- 3. Analysis Approach – Describe the charts, formulas, and metrics you used.
- 4. Key Insights – Highlight the most important findings from your analysis.
- 5. Visual Storytelling – Explain how you used visuals to make data easy to understand.
- 6. Creative Recommendations – Suggest actions based on your insights.
- 7. Business Impact – End with how your analysis influenced decisions or actions.

## Practice Case Prompt:

You are analyzing CPI inflation data for 12 months across Food, Fuel, and Core components. Your goal is to determine which component drives inflation, spot seasonal patterns, and identify risks for the future.

### *Excel Tasks:*

- Create a line chart for Food, Fuel, and Core inflation over time.
- Calculate month-over-month percentage change for each component.
- Build a 3-month moving average for trend smoothing.
- Identify the most volatile component.
- Create a stacked column chart showing contribution to total inflation.
- Summarize findings and propose one creative recommendation.

## Communication Tips for Interviews:

- Start with the 'why' – explain why this analysis matters to the business.
- Keep technical details simple unless the interviewer asks for more depth.
- Use strong transition phrases like 'What stood out to me was…' or 'From a business perspective…'
- Always connect your findings to possible actions or decisions.
- Maintain confident and clear body language during explanation.